

BASKETBALL

National Youth Player

Egypt — competed at regional & national youth level

Coach

Youth & community teams, 10+ years, 500+ players developed

Global Perspective

NBA, EuroLeague, FIBA, grassroots — all markets

The Culture

Jordan era to present — the sport as entertainment

CORE SKILLS

Event Production & Activation

Fan Experience Design

Global Operations

Brand & Partnerships

Community Building

Entertainment & Creative

Stakeholder Management

LANGUAGES

Arabic Native

English Native

French Excellent

Spanish Excellent

Dutch Working

Polish Working

Portuguese Basic

Italian Basic

Romanian Basic

GLOBAL REACH

100+ countries

visited & operated in

3 continents

of primary operations (MENA, Europe, Americas)

40+ countries

with direct operational delivery

EDUCATION

PROFILE

Entrepreneurial events and activations leader with **27+ years building public experiences, fan moments, and brand activations** at global scale — and a lifelong basketball player and coach with genuine insider fluency. Built a 140-person event agency in Dubai, delivered activations for the FIFA Club World Cup, Paris 2024 Olympics, and COP 27/26/29 across 40+ countries. I think entertainment-first, operate under pressure, and believe the NBA's greatest opportunity lives beyond the arena.

EXPERIENCE

ABAZA BUSINESS SERVICES

Jan 2019 – Present

FOUNDER & DIRECTOR Netherlands

- Delivered activations and event operations for the **FIFA Club World Cup** and the **Paris 2024 Olympic Games** — operating at the highest level of global sports production
- Designed and delivered **end-to-end activations for COP 27 (Egypt), COP 26 (UAE), and COP 29 (Azerbaijan)** — coordinating multinational teams and on-site logistics at true global scale
- Built agile operational frameworks enabling complex multi-country programs to run reliably across time zones under high-stakes conditions
- Strategic advisor on event design, logistics, and delivery for senior government and corporate clients — translating creative vision into structured execution plans

WITHLOCALS B.V.

Nov 2018 – Jun 2026

CHIEF GROWTH OFFICER Eindhoven, Netherlands

- Owned full-funnel demand growth for a global travel marketplace — from new market entry and supply acquisition to host activation, retention, and corporate revenue conversion; scaled from 50 to **300+ cities across 40+ countries**
- Built and scaled a community of **2,000+ experience hosts**; designed the onboarding programs, engagement systems, and host tooling that drove quality, retention, and performance at scale
- Generated demand across digital and experiential channels, growing the platform to serve **70+ global corporate clients**; pivoted the full product and demand model to virtual during COVID-19, opening a new B2B revenue stream

SPHERE EVENTS & COMMUNICATION

Jan 2008 – Nov 2018

FOUNDER & MANAGING DIRECTOR Dubai, UAE

- Founded and scaled a regional event & communications agency into a **140-person operation delivering 150+ projects per year**, generating USD 8M+ in annual revenue at peak
- Led major public entertainment events including **Street Nights, Dubai Chocolate Festival, and Marina Music Festival** — designing crowd experiences from zero for audiences of tens of thousands
- Partnered with global brands (Adidas, Emirates Airlines, Abu Dhabi Tourism, FIFA, Siemens, Porsche, Emaar) on activations blending creative ambition with flawless operational delivery across the region
- Built cross-functional teams (production, design, logistics, client services) and the systems and supplier networks to sustain high performance in high-pressure environments

FRONTFLIP (ME360)

Mar 2010 – Oct 2013

CEO, MIDDLE EAST & NORTH AFRICA Kansas City, USA / MENA

- Co-founded regional operations of a mobile loyalty startup; raised USD 1.8M in early-stage funding; built a 25-person cross-functional team
- Delivered major experiential brand partnerships with **Budweiser** and **McDonald's** — including large-scale activations for the **Super Bowl XLVII (2013)** with Budweiser
- Led market localization and UX design for one of the region's earliest app-based customer engagement platforms

ASDAA BURSON-MARSTELLER

2005 – 2006

B.Sc. Computer Engineering

Arab Academy for Science,
Technology & Maritime Transport,
Alexandria

SENIOR ACCOUNT MANAGER Dubai, UAE

- Played a key role in launching the **inaugural Dubai International Film Festival** — managing stakeholder engagement and communications at global scale
- Led accounts for multinational clients including Siemens, Adidas, and Hilton across high-profile campaigns and public events

SUNDANCE EVENTS

2004 – 2005